



OUTLIERS

Capture

Layer 4 of 8 · Where the typing stops,
and the system starts filling itself.

EST. MMXXVI · OUTLIERS ACCELERATOR

It fills itself

Everything so far has been groundwork. This is the layer where your CRM starts holding a history you did not type.

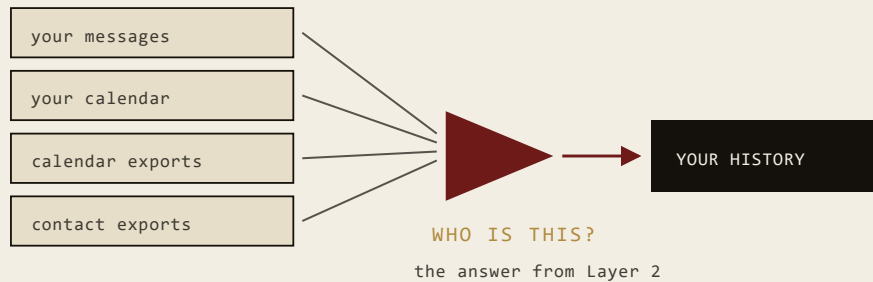
WHAT THE LAST LAYER LEFT YOU WITH

You have a place to record what happened and rules for working out everything else from it. What you do not have is anything putting the history in, which leaves you typing, which is the thing that kills CRMs.

WHAT THIS LAYER BUILDS

Small programs that read an export from a place your conversations already happen and turn every row of it into history. You run one command against the file, and nothing is typed. Running the same export again adds nothing twice, so you can drop a newer one on top whenever you like.

PLACES YOU ALREADY TALK TO PEOPLE



HOW OFTEN IT LOOKS AT

people you are talking to
every time something happens

people who have gone quiet
once a month

everyone else
now and then

a reply jumps the queue

EVERY SOURCE GOES THROUGH THE SAME QUESTION BEFORE ANYTHING IS WRITTEN DOWN.

How it works

Collecting the records is straightforward. Working out which person each one belongs to is not, and that is most of this layer.

WORKING OUT WHO EACH RECORD BELONGS TO

Getting a list of messages out of somewhere is straightforward. The difficulty is that the same human turns up as a profile in one place, an email address in another, and a first name on a meeting invitation in a third, while two genuinely different people share a name.

So everything a collector finds goes through the same question first, using the answer you built in Layer 2: **who is this?** Nothing is written down until that is settled. A record filed against the wrong person corrupts every calculation above it, and silently, which makes it far worse than a thing not filed at all.

When your system genuinely cannot tell who something belongs to, it records it anyway and marks it unattributed. Throwing it away would leave the history looking complete when it is not.

NOT EVERYTHING NEEDS LOOKING AT AS OFTEN

You cannot re-check everything constantly, and checking nothing lets the whole thing go stale. So contacts sit in three groups. People you are actively talking to are refreshed whenever something happens, which costs nothing extra. Warm contacts get looked at occasionally. Everyone else, rarely.

Anything that actually happens overrides that schedule: a reply is picked up straight away rather than waiting its turn.

NOTHING HERE USES AI

These are small, boring programs that do the same thing every time and can be tested by giving them a known input and checking the output. That is deliberate. You want the part of your system that decides what is true to be predictable. Judgement arrives in the next layer, on top of this, where you can see it and check it.

Build it

One command. It asks you a few questions so what you get is yours, then does the work.

```
git clone https://github.com/OUTLIERS-ai/outliers-crm-04-capture
cd outliers-crm-04-capture
python install.py
```

This layer needs Layers 1 to 3. It checks first and tells you if anything is missing.

WHAT IT ASKS YOU, AND WHY

QUESTION	WHAT IT CHANGES
Where do your conversations actually happen?	Messages, email, calls, meetings, a community. Pick the ones that matter; you can add more later.
Which of those can you export or connect?	Most platforms let you download your own data. The installer walks you through the ones you pick, and skips anything you cannot get at yet.

WHAT YOU END UP WITH

- A collector for each source you connected, each writing into your one history.
- Every incoming item passed through the same identity check before it is filed.
- A refresh schedule so your records are re-checked in proportion to how much they matter.

Now use it

Connect one source, and read a history you did not type.

Connect one source. Just one, the easiest one you have.

Then open the record of someone you have not thought about in a while and read their history. Depending which source you chose, you may find exchanges you had forgotten and meetings you had lost track of. The system records that things happened and when, not what was said in them.

Nobody typed any of it. That is what the first three layers were for.

IF YOU ALREADY HAD SOMETHING LIKE THIS

Your test: pick a person and count how many separate places their history currently lives. If the answer is more than one, you have several partial records of the same relationship and no single view of it. That is what this layer removes.

WHAT THIS LAYER LEAVES UNSOLVED

Your system can now tell you what happened. It cannot tell you what any of it means. Whether this person is worth an hour of your week, whether a reply is genuinely warm or merely polite, and what to say back are all judgements, and a small program cannot make them.

NEXT: LAYER 5 • JUDGEMENT

Assistants that read, score and draft, each with one job, each showing where every fact it writes down came from.

WORDS USED IN THIS GUIDE

Collector	A small program that watches one source and records what happens there.
Attribution	Deciding which person something belongs to.
Unattributed	Something recorded that the system could not confidently assign to anyone.
Refresh	Looking again at details that may have changed, such as a job title.